Attachment 9

Description of Participant Recruitment

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

Janne Tukiainen | janne.tukiainen@utu.fi | Version 2.6 – proposed amendment | 20 October 2026

Population and selection

The target is 300 adults who complete the experiment, recruited for sessions planned between 1 and 31 October 2026 through the UTU Choice Lab decision-making laboratory ~~and, if needed to accelerate recruitment, Tampere University's Decision-making Laboratory (DMLab)~~. Eligibility is limited to people aged 18 or older who can understand the study language and attend the full approximately 60-minute session. Political opinions, past party vote, prior game experience, academic field, and expected choices are not used to select participants. Political background is asked only in an optional post-task questionnaire and is not available during recruitment.

~~The host laboratory~~ UTU Choice Lab will distribute the approved neutral advertisement through its participant system and usual scheduling channels: UTU Choice Lab uses UTU RPP/TOKA~~, and DMLab uses ORSEE~~. Interested individuals voluntarily book an available session. The interactive task requires a completed roster divisible by five and capped at 20, with a minimum of five. ~~Ten-person matching pools are formed first; a fifteen-person pool is used when the usable roster is 15. Thus, 10 participants form one ten-person pool and two temporary five-person groups per round; 15 form one fifteen-person pool and three groups; and 20 form two ten-person pools and four groups~~ Five, ten, or fifteen participants form one pool of that size, while twenty form two ten-person pools. Ten- and fifteen-person pools are reshuffled into two or three five-person groups each round. In a five-person pool, the same participants play together throughout. If 1–4 additional people arrive, the ~~host laboratory applies its arrival-order and compensation rules~~ researcher or trained research assistant applies the study's attendance and compensation procedure and releases the surplus before paid play. No participant enters or changes matching pools after the task begins. Duplicate participation is prevented through the ~~host laboratory's~~ UTU Choice Lab's scheduling records.

Recruitment and scheduling information is administered separately from experimental responses. ~~The host laboratory retains the identifying information needed for attendance and payment and gives researchers only coded experimental data. The research team never receives any temporary identity-to-code link; the host laboratory removes it after payment under its procedure. Each laboratory administers its participant register under its own privacy notice.~~ UTU RPP/TOKA retains registration and attendance information under its own privacy notice. It does not assign oTree participant codes, receive experimental responses, or administer payments. oTree generates the participant codes used in the task. The research team administers payment separately from the research dataset. No teacher, employer, or direct supervisor will recruit subordinates, and participation or refusal will not affect studies, employment, grades, services, or future eligibility for unrelated research.

Information and consent procedure

The invitation gives the study location, duration, broad topic, eligibility, and expected payment without disclosing directional hypotheses. Registration through ~~the host laboratory's participant system~~ UTU RPP/TOKA provides its general rules and privacy information. Before any practice or paid task, oTree presents concise project-specific information, the location of the research privacy notice, and Janne Tukiainen's contact details. It explains that the detailed research question will be disclosed after the paid task to avoid influencing the decisions under study. Participants may ask the researcher or ~~laboratory manager~~ trained research assistant questions.

The same first oTree screen records a short study-specific confirmation. Participants affirm that they are at least 18, have read the study information, understand the duration, interaction, payment, risks, limited incomplete disclosure and post-task debrief, and coded-data arrangements, and voluntarily agree to participate. The system records the response, form version, date, time, and laboratory site. This confirmation supplements rather than replaces ~~the host laboratory's~~ UTU Choice Lab's general participant agreement. A person who does not agree does not enter the interactive task. The ~~laboratory manager~~ researcher or trained research assistant then finalises or relaunches the roster so that only consenting participants and complete five-person groups enter Block 1.

Participants may stop later without giving a reason. Because the task is synchronized, they are asked to notify the ~~laboratory manager~~ researcher or trained research assistant, who manages the interruption without generating a decision or allowing another person to inherit their experimental history. The fixed participation payment and any performance earnings are handled ~~under the approved laboratory procedure~~ by the research team in the separate payment procedure. Data already collected are processed as stated in the privacy notice.

Compensation and follow-up

Participants receive EUR 10 plus a points-based performance bonus of up to EUR 5, determined by one randomly selected round from each block. The maximum total payment is EUR 15. ~~Payment administration and any legally required reporting information remain separate from research responses. The host laboratory removes any temporary identity-to-code link after payment; researchers cannot subsequently use the coded dataset to identify a participant.~~ The research team pays participants immediately using a separate oTree code-and-amount list. Any payment receipt or reporting record is kept separately and does not contain an oTree code. The code-and-amount list is securely deleted after payment reconciliation. Coded data remain restricted personal data until a documented disclosure-risk review confirms anonymisation. No additional contact is planned after payment.

The first complete ten-person session offers six optional pretest feedback questions before the debrief and payment display. Participants receive the same separate form address, without an individual link or study code. Participation in this feedback has no effect on payment or eligibility for unrelated research.